

JIM'S TICK & MOSQUITO

QUICK OPERATIONS GUIDE

Simplified Employee Manual

Plain language. Daily expectations. When to stop and ask.

THIS GUIDE IS THE SHORT VERSION

Use this guide to understand the job and the company's basic rules. It does not replace the full Operations, Growth & Expansion Manual, the pesticide label, Massachusetts law, or equipment manufacturer instructions. When they conflict, the controlling law/label/manual wins.

Companion to: Jim's Tick & Mosquito - Operations, Growth & Expansion Manual
2027 Launch + Long-Term Scaling Framework

How to Use This Guide

Read this first. The goal is to make the job understandable without making you memorize the entire main manual.

THE SIMPLE RULE

If you know the normal procedure, follow it. If something is unusual, unsafe, unclear, outside the label, or outside your training - stop and ask Jim or the designated supervisor.

What this guide covers

- What the company does and what customers should expect.
- How to start the day and prepare your route.
- What to do at each property.
- Basic pesticide and equipment safety.
- How to communicate with customers.
- What must be documented.
- How weather and callbacks affect the schedule.
- What counts as an incident or reason to stop work.
- What decisions require approval.

What this guide does NOT replace

- The pesticide label.
- Massachusetts pesticide law and licensing rules.
- The full Jim's Tick & Mosquito Operations, Growth & Expansion Manual.
- Product Safety Data Sheets (SDS).
- Manufacturer manuals for vehicles, pumps, backpacks, reels, engines, batteries, or other equipment.

WHERE TO LOOK FOR DETAILS

Each section in this guide includes a "Main Manual" reference. If you need the technical, legal, financial, or management detail, go there.

1. What Kind of Company Is This?

This section explains the basic promise we make to customers and how the service is organized.

IN ONE SENTENCE

Jim's Tick & Mosquito is a locally owned, owner-led Cape Cod service company that provides recurring tick and mosquito treatments with consistent communication, careful application, and accountable service.

What customers are buying

- A recurring seasonal tick and mosquito service - not a one-time "magic spray."
- The standard program uses 7 treatments, normally about 4 weeks apart.
- The company goal is fewer ticks and mosquitoes and a better outdoor experience - never a guarantee of total elimination.
- Customers should know when we are coming, what was done, and who to contact if there is a problem.

What matters most

- Safety before speed.
- Do the job the same way every time.
- Follow the label and company procedure.
- Treat the customer and property with respect.
- Write down what happened so the next person does not have to guess.
- Ask before improvising.

MAIN MANUAL

See Sections 1-5 for company strategy, business model, route capacity, scheduling, services, pricing, and scope.

2. Before You Leave for the Route

A good day usually starts before the first property. Most avoidable problems come from leaving unprepared.

Route check

- ☐ Review today's route in GorillaDesk.
- ☐ Confirm customer addresses, access notes, gates, pets, and special instructions.
- ☐ Check the weather and decide whether conditions are suitable.
- ☐ Know which properties are standard, large, sensitive, or need special attention.

Vehicle and equipment check

- ☐ Vehicle is safe to drive and cargo is secured.
- ☐ Backpack(s) are clean, working, calibrated, and not leaking.
- ☐ Tank/skid system is secure and working if the route uses one.
- ☐ PPE is present and usable.
- ☐ Spill kit is complete.
- ☐ Products, measuring tools, labels/SDS, and customer materials are available.
- ☐ Phone/tablet is charged.

DO NOT START THE ROUTE WITH A KNOWN PROBLEM

A leaking sprayer, broken hose, missing PPE, unsecured load, or questionable calibration is not "good enough for today." Fix it, swap equipment, or call before leaving.

MAIN MANUAL

See Sections 9, 10, 12, 13, 14, and 15 for product control, daily field procedure, vehicles, equipment operation, maintenance, and field readiness.

3. What to Do at Every Property

Every property follows the same basic sequence so important steps are not forgotten.

The property sequence

1. Confirm you are at the correct address and the correct customer.
2. Review the service and property notes before starting.
3. Check gates, pets, people, toys, dishes, irrigation, and other access concerns.
4. Look for sensitive areas: blooming plants, beehives, food plants, ponds, wetlands, drains, wells, or areas the customer excluded.
5. Decide whether the service can safely proceed.
6. Apply only the approved product, method, and rate for the job.
7. Watch the application continuously for leaks, drift, equipment problems, or changing conditions.
8. When finished, secure gates and leave the property as you found it.
9. Complete the service record before the details are forgotten.
10. Send/leave the required completion information.

STOP BEFORE YOU GUESS

If the property is different from what you expected - new pond, beehive, major construction, unusual vegetation, angry dog, access problem, large area, or anything that changes the treatment decision - stop and ask.

MAIN MANUAL

See Sections 8, 9, and 10 for IPM, application controls, property assessment, sensitive areas, and the full field procedure.

4. Pesticide Safety - The Basics

You do not need to memorize every label. You do need to know that the label controls the job.

THE LABEL IS NOT A SUGGESTION

Never use a pesticide in a way that conflicts with its current label. If you do not understand the label, rate, site, PPE, or restriction, do not guess.

Always

- Use only company-approved products.
- Use the correct measuring equipment.
- Use the required PPE.
- Use the company-approved calibration and setup.
- Keep products secured during transport.
- Protect people, pets, water, pollinators, and other sensitive areas.
- Stop if weather or drift conditions become unsuitable.

Never

- Change the rate because you think “more will work better.”
- Mix in an unapproved product or additive.
- Treat a site the label does not allow.
- Spray through a leak or equipment failure.
- Use another employee's “favorite mix” unless it is an approved company procedure.
- Make disease-prevention or guaranteed-elimination claims to customers.

GENERAL-USE MODEL

Normal company operations are built around general-use pesticide work performed by properly licensed technicians. Restricted-use products require a different compliance process.

MAIN MANUAL

See Sections 8, 9, 11, and 19 for IPM, labels, calibration, licensing/compliance, and source control.

5. Talking to Customers

Customers usually remember whether we were clear, respectful, and responsive just as much as they remember the spray itself.

Normal communication

- Be polite, simple, and professional.
- Explain what you can explain confidently. Do not bluff.
- If you do not know the answer, say you will have Jim/the supervisor follow up.
- Do not criticize another company to make ours look better.
- Do not promise that a property will be pest-free.
- Do not promise that treatment will prevent Lyme disease or another illness.

If a customer is unhappy

11. Listen first.
12. Do not argue.
13. Get the facts.
14. Record the concern.
15. Explain what you can do within company policy.
16. Escalate anything involving exposure, injury, drift, damage, refund demands, repeated complaints, or unusual re-treatment requests.

CUSTOMER BELONGS TO THE COMPANY

Be friendly and build trust, but keep notes in GorillaDesk so the customer experience does not depend on one employee remembering everything.

MAIN MANUAL

See Sections 7 and 10 for customer experience, retention, service recovery, communication, and escalation.

6. Records and GorillaDesk

If the work was not recorded correctly, the company may not be able to prove what happened or service the customer consistently.

After each service, record what actually happened

- ☐ Correct customer/property.
- ☐ Date/time as required by the workflow.
- ☐ Product used.
- ☐ Amount used as required.
- ☐ Target pest/purpose.
- ☐ Application method.
- ☐ Actual applicator/technician.
- ☐ Important property conditions or exclusions.
- ☐ Incidents, complaints, access problems, or unusual observations.

DO NOT BACKFILL FROM MEMORY AT THE END OF THE WEEK

Complete records as part of the job. If something is missing or wrong, correct it as soon as you notice it and tell the supervisor when appropriate.

MAIN MANUAL

See Sections 10 and 11 for the full daily documentation and Massachusetts recordkeeping system.

7. Weather, Scheduling, and Route Pressure

The schedule is important, but it never outranks safe application or good work.

How the normal schedule works

- Standard recurring customers are normally serviced on an approximately 4-week rotation.
- The company plans routes geographically so less time is wasted driving.
- A normal mature route may average about 12-15 stops on a field day, but this is not a “hit 15 no matter what” quota.
- Saturday is mainly recovery capacity for weather, callbacks, or unusual disruption - not a permanent sixth production day.

When weather causes problems

- Do not rush to “make up” lost time.
- Do not spray in unsuitable conditions just to protect the calendar.
- Notify the supervisor when backlog is building.
- Keep customers informed when service must move.
- Follow the company’s route-recovery plan rather than improvising your own customer schedule.

THE ROUTE SHOULD SURVIVE A BAD WEATHER DAY

If the schedule only works when nothing goes wrong, it is too tight. Report chronic backlog, overtime, or Saturday dependence.

MAIN MANUAL

See Sections 4, 10, 17, and 18 for capacity, four-week scheduling, weather recovery, and operating calendar.

8. Vehicles and Equipment

The company may use different trucks or vans, but every route must follow the same safety and readiness rules.

Vehicle rules

- Do not overload the vehicle.
- Secure tanks, backpacks, products, tools, and other cargo.
- Keep the driver area clear.
- Report warning lights, tire problems, brake concerns, leaks, or unsafe handling.
- Keep spill equipment accessible.

Equipment rules

- Inspect before use.
- Use only calibrated equipment.
- Do not use a damaged hose, gun, backpack, pump, or fitting.
- Tag unsafe equipment OUT OF SERVICE.
- Do only field repairs you are trained and authorized to perform.
- Report repeated equipment problems instead of repeatedly "making it work."

BACKPACK-FIRST

The normal residential method is backpack application. Direct skid/hose application is optional and must be specifically appropriate and approved for the job.

MAIN MANUAL

See Sections 12-15 for vehicle selection, payload, equipment operation, maintenance, spare parts, and incident readiness.

9. Incidents and Emergencies

The priority is people first, then containment, then fast communication and documentation.

IF SOMETHING SERIOUS HAPPENS

Stop the work. Protect people. Control the source if it is safe to do so. Notify Jim/the supervisor immediately. Do not hide it, minimize it, or wait until the end of the day.

Examples

- Human exposure concern.
- Pet/livestock exposure concern.
- Large spill or leak.
- Off-target application or drift complaint.
- Water contamination concern.
- Property damage.
- Vehicle accident involving pesticide cargo.
- Customer reports illness/injury related to the treatment.
- Equipment failure that may have affected application accuracy.

Simple incident sequence

17. STOP the source if safe.
18. PROTECT people first; follow label first aid and call 911 when necessary.
19. CONTAIN the release without washing it into drains, wetlands, wells, or surface water.
20. NOTIFY Jim/the supervisor immediately.
21. DOCUMENT product, amount, location, time, weather, people, actions, photos, and witnesses when appropriate.
22. TAG damaged equipment OUT OF SERVICE.

MAIN MANUAL

See Sections 11 and 15 for regulatory reporting, incident files, insurance notification, spill response, and emergency details.

10. What You Can Decide - and What Needs Approval

Good technicians use judgment. Good technicians also know where their authority ends.

Normally within the technician's job

- Follow the scheduled route.
- Perform the approved service exactly as trained.
- Use the approved product/rate/method.
- Pause for obvious unsafe conditions.
- Communicate routine arrival/completion information.
- Document normal property conditions.
- Perform authorized minor equipment care.

Stop and get approval for

- Changing product, rate, mix, additive, or application method.
- Treating a site not clearly covered by the normal service.
- Direct skid application when it was not planned/approved.
- Unusual treatment near a sensitive site.
- Major re-service or repeated callback.
- Refund, major discount, free service, or scope change.
- Customer request that conflicts with the label or company procedure.
- Any incident, suspected exposure, damage, or drift complaint.
- Equipment problem that may affect safe/calibrated application.
- Anything you are not confident is correct.

A GOOD ESCALATION IS NOT A FAILURE

Calling before making a bad decision protects the customer, the technician, and the company.

MAIN MANUAL

See Sections 5, 9, 10, 11, and 15 for service scope, application controls, escalation, compliance, and incidents.

11. Things We Do Not Do

These are simple guardrails that prevent many of the worst mistakes.

- NO** We do not guess pesticide rates or mix “a little extra.”
- NO** We do not use products that are not on the company-approved list.
- NO** We do not treat through unsafe weather, drift, leaks, or equipment problems.
- NO** We do not promise zero ticks, zero mosquitoes, or disease prevention.
- NO** We do not argue with customers.
- NO** We do not hide mistakes or incidents.
- NO** We do not falsify, copy, or backdate application records.
- NO** We do not leave gates unsecured or ignore pet/access notes.
- NO** We do not make unauthorized price promises, refunds, or discounts.
- NO** We do not perform unfamiliar major repairs in the field.
- NO** We do not overload or improperly secure a route vehicle.
- NO** We do not let schedule pressure outrank safety, label compliance, or quality.

MAIN MANUAL

These guardrails are explained throughout Sections 5-15. When you need the “why,” use the full manual.

12. Simple Terms and Acronyms

You do not need a business degree or pesticide-law background to use this manual. These are the common terms.

Calibration - Measuring and adjusting application equipment so it delivers the intended amount correctly.

Callback - A return visit or follow-up caused by a concern, complaint, or need for additional evaluation.

Customer-equivalent - An internal workload number. A normal recurring customer is usually 1.0; unusually large or frequent work may count as more.

EPA - U.S. Environmental Protection Agency.

Four-week rotation - The normal recurring schedule: customers are generally serviced about every four weeks.

GorillaDesk - The company's main customer, scheduling, service-record, agreement, and payment system.

IPM - Integrated Pest Management - inspect, reduce habitat/problems where possible, treat deliberately, monitor, and educate.

MDAR - Massachusetts Department of Agricultural Resources - the state agency responsible for pesticide licensing and major pesticide regulation.

PPE - Personal Protective Equipment - gloves, eye protection, clothing, or other protection required for the task/product.

Route density - How close customers are to each other. Dense routes mean less driving and more productive field time.

SDS - Safety Data Sheet - chemical safety, handling, first aid, and emergency information.

Service obligation - Work the company has promised or been paid to perform but has not completed yet.

Weather buffer - Unused schedule capacity saved for rain, wind, callbacks, equipment problems, and other disruptions.

MORE DEFINITIONS

The full manual contains the larger acronym and plain-English glossary for financial, legal, management, route, and pesticide terms.

13. Where to Find the Full Answer

This page tells you which section of the main manual to open when the quick guide is not enough.

Question / Topic	Main Manual Section
Company mission / growth plan	1-3
Route capacity / four-week scheduling	4
Services / prices / scope	5
Sales / canvassing / acquisition	6
Customer experience / complaints / retention	7
IPM / property assessment	8
Products / labels / calibration	9
Daily field procedure	10
Licenses / application records / compliance	11
Vehicles / payload / rig setup	12
Cleaning / operation / winterization	13
Preventive maintenance	14
Tools / spares / incidents	15
Financial system / owner pay / expansion money	16
Dashboards / checklists / thresholds	17
Annual calendar / seasonal workflow	18
Sources / labels / annual verification	19

FULL MANUAL CONTROLS THE DETAILS

Use this Quick Guide to orient yourself. Use the Main Manual whenever the situation requires exact procedure, legal detail, technical settings, management rules, or a decision outside normal field work.

14. One-Page Daily Field Checklist

Use this as a memory aid. It is not a replacement for the route notes, label, or full procedure.

Before leaving

- ☐ Route reviewed
- ☐ Weather checked
- ☐ Vehicle safe / load secured
- ☐ PPE present
- ☐ Sprayers inspected / calibrated
- ☐ Products + measuring tools ready
- ☐ Spill kit ready
- ☐ Phone/tablet charged
- ☐ Customer materials ready

At each property

- ☐ Correct address/customer
- ☐ Notes/access reviewed
- ☐ People/pets/gates checked
- ☐ Sensitive areas checked
- ☐ Safe to proceed
- ☐ Approved product/method only
- ☐ Watch for drift/leaks/problems
- ☐ Property secured when finished
- ☐ Record completed
- ☐ Customer completion information sent/left

End of day

- ☐ All jobs closed out in GorillaDesk
- ☐ Problems/complaints escalated
- ☐ Product/equipment issues reported
- ☐ Equipment secured/cleaned as required
- ☐ Batteries charging
- ☐ Vehicle/route restocked for next day

WHEN IN DOUBT

STOP -> MAKE THE AREA SAFE -> CHECK THE LABEL/ROUTE NOTES -> CALL JIM OR THE DESIGNATED SUPERVISOR -> DOCUMENT WHAT HAPPENED.

Final Reminder

The job is not to move as fast as possible. The job is to perform reliable, safe, repeatable service that the customer and company can trust.

THE FIVE THINGS TO REMEMBER

1. Follow the label.
2. Inspect before you treat.
3. Do not guess.
4. Write down what happened.
5. Tell someone immediately when something goes wrong.

If this Quick Guide and the Main Manual disagree, use the controlling current law/label/manufacturer instruction and notify management so the documents can be corrected.

JIM'S TICK & MOSQUITO

Locally owned. Owner-led. Professionally trained.